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阅读 C

养宠物的环境代价之争

说明文 · 环境与生活 · 全文 358 词 · 逐句精读

¹ The pet food **industry** has received **unkind** **remarks** **as to** the true **origin** of its **ingredients** (原料) for **decades**.

几十年来，宠物食品行业在原料的真正来源问题上一直饱受尖刻的非议。

industry n. 行业；产业

unkind adj. 不友善的；刻薄的

remark n. 评论；言论

as to 关于；至于

origin n. 来源；起源

ingredient n. 原料；成分

decade n. 十年

² Now the industry **faces** another **source** of **criticism** as a new book starts a **debate** about the **environmental impact** of owning a **well-fed** pet.

如今，随着一本新书引发了一场关于“养一只吃得好的宠物会对环境造成什么影响”的争论，这个行业又多了一个招致批评的缘由。

face v. 面临

source n. 来源；根源

criticism n. 批评

debate n. 争论；辩论

environmental adj. 环境的

impact n. 影响

well-fed adj. 吃得好的；喂养充足的

- 3 The New Scientist **magazine**, in a recent **editorial**, **largely** **agreed with** the book's **findings** that some pets, **due to** the food they eat, have a **surprisingly** high “**ecological footprint**”, which is a way of **quantifying** human **demand** on the planet's **ecosystems** using a **measure** called “global **hectares**”.

《新科学家》杂志在最近的一篇社论中基本认同这本书的研究结论：一些宠物由于所吃的食物，“生态足迹”高得出人意料。“生态足迹”是一种量化人类对地球生态系统需求的方法，所用的计量单位叫作“全球公顷”。

magazine n. 杂志

editorial n. 社论

largely adv. 很大程度上；基本上

agree with 同意；赞同

finding n. 研究成果；发现

due to 由于

surprisingly adv. 出人意料地

ecological adj. 生态的

footprint n. 足迹

quantify v. 量化

demand n. 需求

ecosystem n. 生态系统

measure n. 计量单位；衡量标准

hectare n. 公顷

4 According to the authors of the book, “A shocking comparison is that in 2004, the average citizen of some poor countries had an eco-footprint of 0.76 hectares.

据这本书的作者称：“一个令人震惊的对比是：2004年，一些贫穷国家普通公民的生态足迹为0.76公顷。

according to 根据；据……所说

author n. 作者

shocking adj. 令人震惊的

comparison n. 比较；对比

average adj. 普通的；一般的

citizen n. 公民

eco-footprint n. 生态足迹

⁵ The eco-footprint of a **medium-sized** dog is about 0.84 hectares, and that of a cat is about 0.15 hectares, almost **the same as** what is needed to **run** a small car.

一只中型犬的生态足迹约为0.84公顷，一只猫的约为0.15公顷，几乎和开一辆小汽车所需的一样多。

medium-sized adj. 中等大小的；中型的

the same as 和……一样

run v. 开（车）；使运转

⁶ In a world where **resources** are already **limited**, can people really **justify** keeping pets that **require** more than some people do?”

在一个资源本已有限的世界里，人们饲养所需资源比一些人还多的宠物，真的说得过去吗？”

resource n. 资源

limited adj. 有限的

justify v. 证明……正当；为……辩护

require v. 需要

⁷ The authors of the book say that they were “genuinely surprised” when calculating the environmental impact of pets.

这本书的作者说，他们在计算宠物对环境的影响时“真的很吃惊”。

genuinely adv. 真正地；确实

calculate v. 计算

environmental adj. 环境的

⁸ And some of the ideas they **put forward** to **attenuate** this **are likely to** **shock** some pet **owners**.

而他们为减轻这种影响提出的一些主张，很可能让一些宠物主人震惊。

put forward 提出

attenuate v. 减轻；减弱

be likely to 很可能

shock v. 使震惊

owner n. 主人；所有者

⁹ For example, the book **suggests** catching **pests** **such as** **field mice** and **processing** them **into** a “**natural**” cat food, or **raising** pets like chickens that provide **both** **company** **and** fresh eggs.

例如，书中建议捕捉田鼠之类的有害动物，把它们加工成“天然”猫粮；或者饲养像鸡这样既能作伴、又能提供新鲜鸡蛋的宠物。

suggest v. 建议

pest n. 害虫；有害动物

such as 例如；像……这样的

field mouse 田鼠

process...into 把……加工成

natural adj. 天然的

raise v. 饲养

both...and 既……又……

company n. 陪伴；作伴

¹⁰ When **feeding** a pet, however, owners are **advised** to **favour** pet foods **made from** chicken meat, which is less **damaging** to the environment than **red meat** and fish.

不过，在喂养宠物时，建议主人优先选择用鸡肉制成的宠物食品，因为鸡肉对环境的危害比红肉和鱼肉小。

feed v. 喂养

advise v. 建议；劝告

favour v. 偏爱；优先选择

be made from 由……制成

damaging adj. 有害的；破坏性的

red meat 红肉

11 As you might **expect**, the Pet Food **Manufacturers Association** (PFMA) **puts up** a **spirited** **defence**, **arguing** that **the vast majority of** meat and fish used in pet foods is of **sufficient** quality for human **consumption** but **surplus to** human needs.

或许不出你所料，宠物食品制造商协会（PFMA）进行了有力的辩护，称宠物食品中使用的肉和鱼绝大多数品质都足以供人类食用，只是超出了人类的需求。

expect v. 预料；预期

manufacturer n. 制造商

association n. 协会

put up 进行（辩护、抵抗等）

spirited adj. 有力的；激烈的

defence n. 辩护；防御

argue v. 主张；论证

the vast majority of 绝大多数

sufficient adj. 足够的；充足的

consumption n. 食用；消耗

surplus to 超出……所需的；多余的

12 “If we didn’t **recycle** animal **by-products** to sell, they might **instead** be **abandoned** and **buried** under the earth, which is not very **green**,” says the PFMA’s **director**.

“如果我们不把动物副产品回收利用起来出售，它们就可能会被丢弃、埋到地下，那可不怎么环保，”该协会的负责人说。

recycle v. 回收利用

by-product n. 副产品

instead adv. 作为替代；代替

abandon v. 丢弃；抛弃

bury v. 埋；掩埋

green adj. 环保的

director n. 负责人；主管

13 In addition, he points out that pets should not be judged just on their carbon footprint.

此外，他指出，不应该仅凭碳足迹来评判宠物。

in addition 此外

point out 指出

judge v. 评判；判断

carbon footprint 碳足迹

14 “Our **environment** is **greatly** **enriched** by the **part** they play in our lives.

“宠物在我们生活中所起的作用极大地丰富了我们的环境。”

environment n. 环境

greatly adv. 极大地

enrich v. 丰富；充实

part n. 作用；角色

¹⁵ Pets in the home **inspire responsibility**, **encourage social awareness** and have **positive** health **benefits**.”

家里的宠物能激发责任感，增强社会意识，还对健康有积极作用。”

inspire v. 激发；激励

responsibility n. 责任感；责任

encourage v. 促进；鼓励

social adj. 社会的

awareness n. 意识

positive adj. 积极的；有益的

benefit n. 益处；好处